Why did Q3 profit dip?

A data story on discounting and margin

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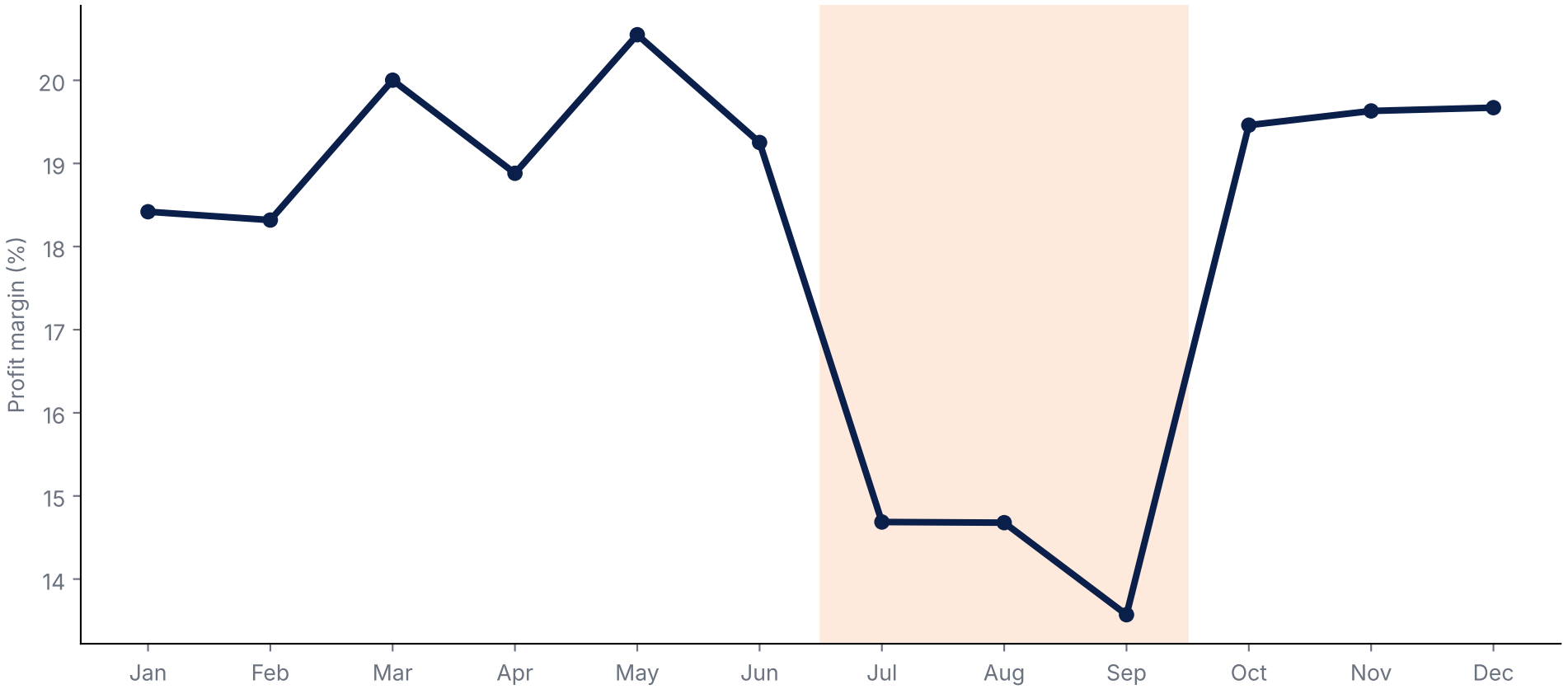
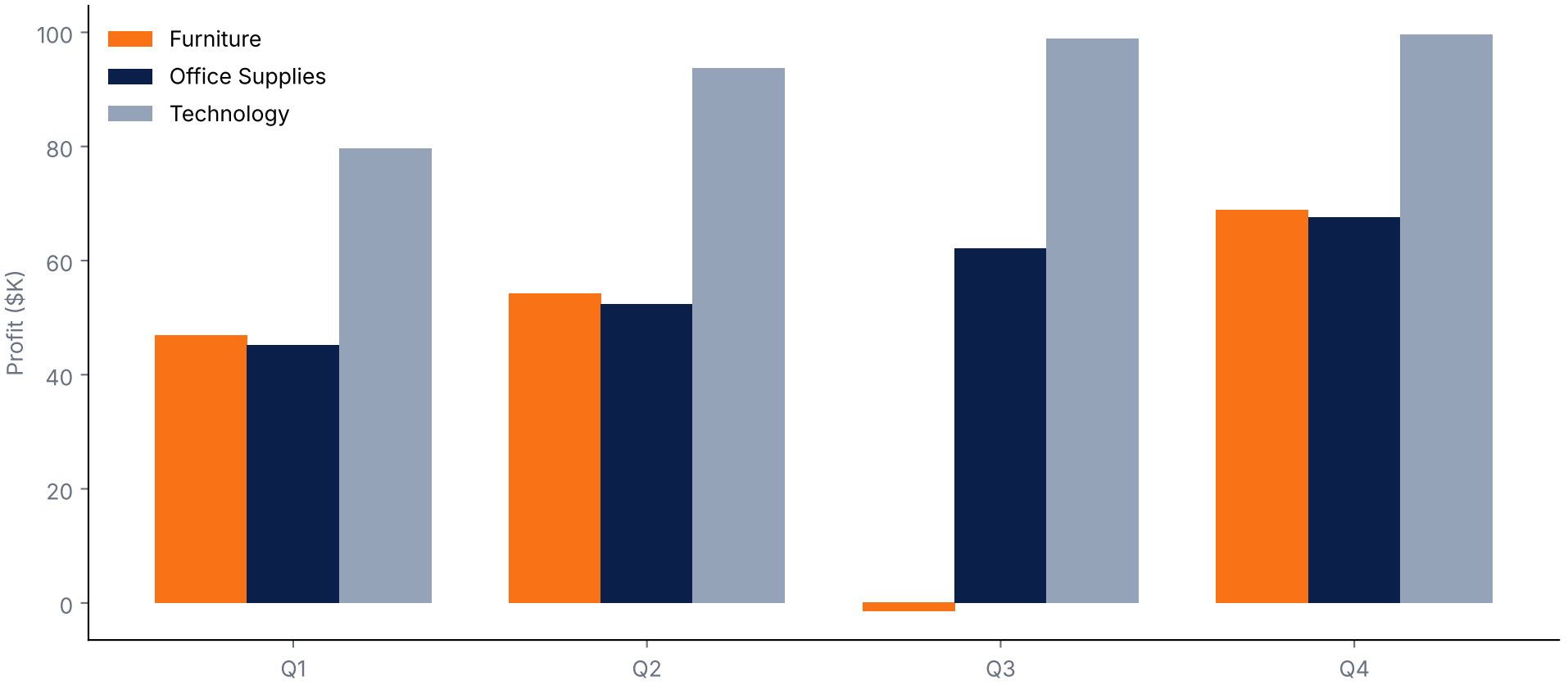
1. Context

Sales kept growing, but profit margin fell in Q3.



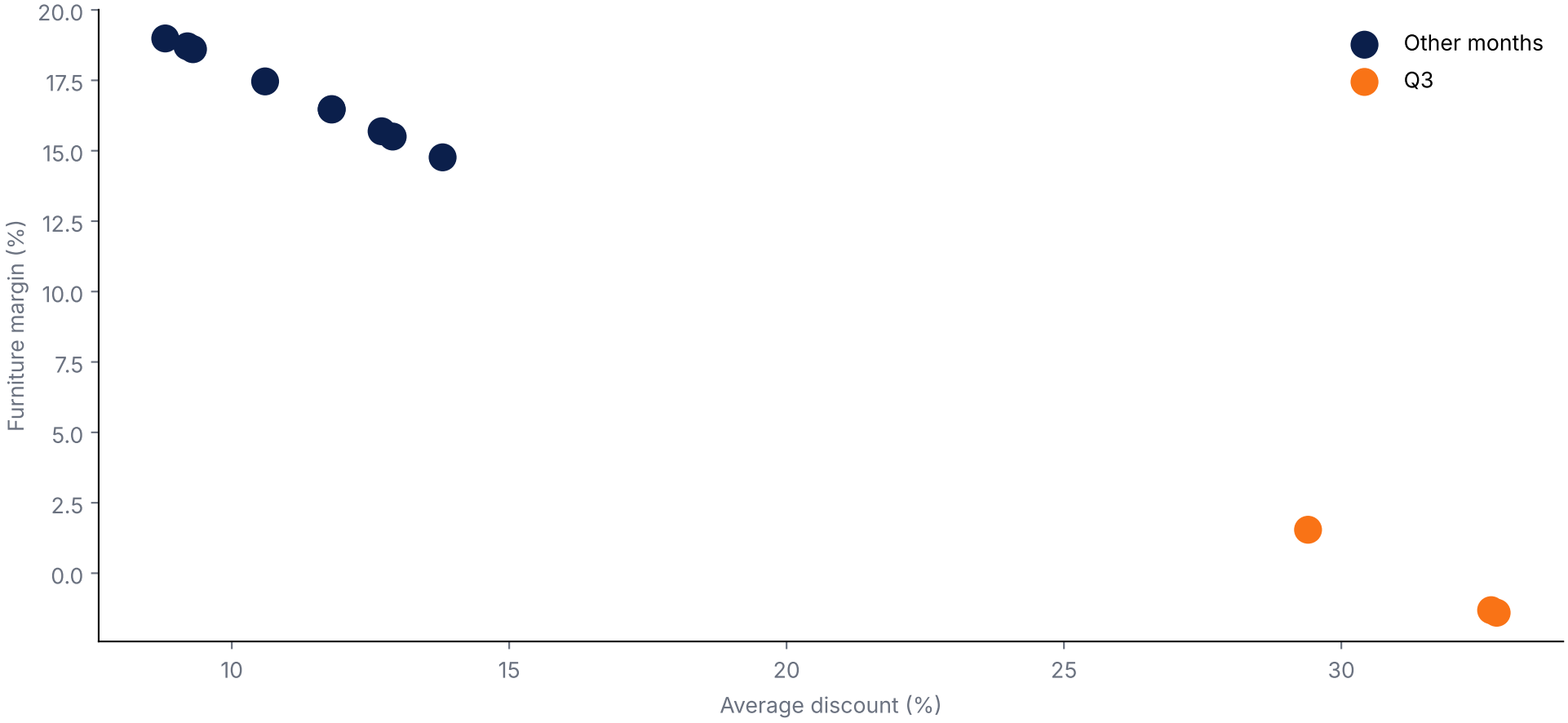
2. Problem

Furniture profit dropped sharply in Q3 while other categories held.



3. Evidence

Higher discounts lined up with lower Furniture margins.



4. Recommendation

Cap discounts and protect margin on Furniture.

1. Set a maximum discount of about 15% on Furniture.

2. Run promotions on high-margin Technology bundles instead.

3. Track margin by category monthly, not just total sales.

Note: illustrative sample data modeled on a retail (Superstore-style) dataset.